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Acer truncatum

Acer truncatum, the **Shantung maple**,[2] **Shandong maple**, or **purpleblow maple**, is a maple native to northern China, in the provinces of Gansu, Hebei, Henan, Jiangsu, Jilin, Liaoning, Inner Mongolia, Shaanxi, Shandong, Shanxi, and to Korea.[3]

It is a medium-sized deciduous tree growing to 15 metres (49 ft) tall with a broad, rounded crown. The bark is smooth on young trees, becoming shallowly ridged with age. The leaves are opposite, palmately lobed with five lobes, 5 centimetres (2.0 in) to 12 centimetres (4.7 in) long and 7 centimetres (2.8 in) to 11 millimetres (0.43 in) broad, with a 3 centimetres (1.2 in) to 10 millimetres (0.39 in) petiole; the lobes are usually entire, but occasionally with a pair of teeth on the largest central lobe, and the margin is often wavy. The petiole bleeds a milky latex when broken. The flowers are in corymbs, yellow-green with five petals 5 millimetres (0.20 in) to 7 millimetres (0.28 in) long; flowering occurs in early spring. The fruit is a double samara with two winged seeds, the seeds are disc-shaped, slightly flattened, 13 millimetres (0.51 in) to 18 millimetres (0.71 in) across. The wings are 2 centimetres (0.79 in) long, widely spread, approaching a 180° angle. The bark is greenish-grey, smooth in young trees, becoming shallowly grooved in mature.[3][4][5] It is drought and heat resistant.[6]

It is closely related to, and often difficult to distinguish from, *Acer amplum*, *Acer cappadocicum*, and *Acer pictum subsp. mono*, which replace it further south and west in China, and in Japan. From *Acer cappadocicum* it is best distinguished by the shoots which turn brown by their first winter, not remaining green for several years.[5] From *Acer mono* (syn. *A. pictum* auct. non Thunb.) it is best distinguished by the larger, thicker (less flattened) seeds. *Acer truncatum* is very unusual among maples in showing hypogeal germination.[7]

Cultivation and uses

Shantung maple is grown as an ornamental plant in Europe and North America.[4][5]

Acer truncatum	
Foliage	
Conservation status	
Extinct: EX, EW; Threatened: CR, EN, VU; Least Concern: NT, LC	
Least Concern (IUCN 3.1)[1]	
Scientific classification	
Kingdom:	Plantae
Clade:	Tracheophytes
Clade:	Angiosperms
Clade:	Eudicots
Clade:	Rosids
Order:	Sapindales
Family:	Sapindaceae
Genus:	*Acer*
Section:	*Acer* sect. *Platanoidea*
Species:	***A. truncatum***
Binomial name	
Acer truncatum Bunge	

A number of cultivars have been selected, including 'Akikaze Nishiki' with variegated leaves, 'Fire Dragon' with very bright autumn colour.[4] The cultivar 'Keithsform' (Norwegian Sunset) is a hybrid between *Acer truncatum* and *Acer platanoides* (Norway Maple).[8]

References

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